BRIGHTSTEPS INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Mockeyville, Grand-Bassam, Côte d'Ivoire

Life Skills Unit Plans

Life Skills

Grade 3 and Grade 4

Grade 3 · Grade 4 (taught together)

2026 – 2027 · Six modules · 18 lessons · Alternate Fridays with SEL

Companion to the Life Skills Scope and Sequence 2026–2027

Internal planning document · October 2026

How to Use These Plans

Grade 3–4, one combined class · 40-minute Life Skills Friday · six modules of three lessons. Life Skills alternates with SEL on Fridays: one Friday SEL, the next Friday Life Skills. Plan one lesson for the whole class; the grade lines give the expected outcome for each child. **Extension** lines stretch children who are ready for more. Grade 5 has no students this year; when it does, Grade 5 children follow the Extension lines. These plans are the companion to the Life Skills Scope and Sequence 2026–2027.

Children learn by doing. Keep teacher talk short and give most of the lesson to hands-on practice: washing, measuring, sewing, counting real money, planting. Every lesson uses free or cheap materials. Collect bottles, cartons, sacks, cloth scraps and product packets from families early in the year.

This year only. About 14 Life Skills Fridays remain from late October, depending on holidays and events. Teach lessons 1 and 2 of every module, and lesson 3 whenever time allows. If a Friday is lost, merge lessons rather than skip a module, so children meet all six strands this year.

- **Knives.** Grade 3–4 use blunt table knives only, on a board or plate, cutting away from the hand. An adult cuts anything hard.
- **Real money.** Children handle real CFA coins and notes. Count the money out and back in at the start and end of each money lesson; keep it in a closed tin.
- **Journals.** Each child keeps a Life Skills journal (an exercise book is fine) for planners, tallies, labels, recipes and short writing. Keep writing short: a list, a table or two sentences.
- **Group work.** Work in mixed groups of four with a Grade 4 child as group leader and clear roles (reader, measurer, recorder, checker). Rotate roles every lesson.
- **Safety first.** No heat or flames in class. Soap and water only; cleaning products are shown as pictures. Outdoor work happens in the shade with water available. Check allergies before every food lesson.
- **Disclosures.** If a child shares something worrying (for example about injuries, hunger or safety at home), follow the safeguarding policy and tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

Evidence. Each child has a Life Skills Passport. When a child shows a skill, stamp or sign it at one of three levels: **Not yet · With help · On my own**. Children can show one Passport skill at the November and March Student Led Conferences.

Internal planning document. In anything families see, describe the approach as inquiry-based learning.

Class materials kit: Life Skills journals, Passports, bar soap, two basins and a jug, two clean spray bottles (free: rinsed plant or hair sprays), black pepper and flour, blunt table knives and plastic plates, measuring spoons and cups, large blunt needles and thick thread, a pinch of real coins and notes in a tin (500 and 1,000 FCFA notes, 5 to 500 FCFA coins), plasters and gauze, a toy or broken phone for call practice, and seeds or dried beans. Free and recycled: plastic bottles and caps, egg cartons, drink and biscuit packets with labels, rice and flour sacks, pagne scraps, old socks and handkerchiefs, cardboard, leaves, soil and market price lists from families.

Module 1 · Taking Care of Me

Goals. Grade 3: explains how germs spread and keeps a daily care routine. Grade 4: plans a full routine and hand-washes socks independently. Extension: explains why each step of a routine matters and helps others organise.

Lesson 1 · How Germs Spread (40 min)

Materials: a bowl of water, ground black pepper, liquid soap or a wet soap bar, a cup of flour, a spray bottle of water with a drop of food colouring, sheets of newspaper or cardboard laid on the floor, tissues, basin, soap and jug for handwashing.

1. **Circle (4 min).** «Name one time today you touched something lots of people touch.» (door handle, ball, money, tap)
2. **Pepper and soap (8 min).** Sprinkle pepper on the bowl of water. «The pepper is germs.» A child dips a dry finger: pepper sticks. A second child dips a finger with soap: the pepper rushes away. «Soap breaks up and lifts germs. Water alone does not.» Groups repeat it with their own bowl if you have them.
3. **Flour handshake (8 min).** One child dusts their hands with flour, then shakes hands with three friends, who each touch a table or a pencil. Look at how far the «germs» travelled. Everyone washes with soap for 20 seconds and checks: is all the flour gone, between fingers and under nails?
4. **Spray-bottle sneeze test (15 min).** Outside in the shade, a child holds the spray bottle at face height and gives one «sneeze» spray over the newspaper. Groups measure how far the coloured drops reach in footsteps. Repeat with the spray aimed into a crooked elbow (a child's sleeve over the nozzle) and into a tissue. Groups record the three distances in their journals. «Where did the germs land each time?»
5. **Close (5 min).** «Germs spread by hands, by sneezes and coughs, and by things we share.» Each child writes two ways they will stop germs this week.

Grade 3: names three ways germs spread and washes hands correctly for 20 seconds. **Grade 4:** records the sneeze-test results and explains what they show. **Extension:** suggests one change to stop germs spreading in the classroom (for example, a tissue box and bin by the door) and explains why.

Check. Watch each child wash their hands for 20 seconds with soap; stamp «I wash my hands well» and «I explain how germs spread».

Tip. Use only clean tap water in the spray bottle and keep the spray away from faces and eyes.

Lesson 2 · My Daily Care Routine (40 min)

Materials: routine planner template in journals (morning, after school, evening columns; body, teeth, hair, nails, clothes rows), a teacher planner as a model, two basins, bar soap, a jug, old socks (one per pair of children; ask families to send them), a string line and clothes pegs or a fence in the sun.

1. **Circle (4 min).** «What is the very first thing you do when you wake up?» Quick round.
2. **Teach (6 min).** Show your planner. Body: wash every day, especially in the heat. Teeth: brush twice a day for two minutes. Hair: wash and comb. Nails: keep short and clean; dirt under nails carries germs. Clothes: clean clothes each day, dirty ones go to the wash. Sleep: 9 to 12 hours a night at our age.
3. **Plan (10 min).** Children fill in their own planner with times and tick boxes. Partners check: «Is anything missing? Is it realistic?»
4. **Bucket-wash socks (16 min).** Pairs at the basins. Wet the sock, rub soap on it, scrub heel and toe against each other, rinse in the second basin, squeeze hard (twist like a rope), shake and peg it out in the sun. Teacher's line: «Inside out first: that is where the sweat is.»
5. **Close (4 min).** «Which part of your routine will be hardest to keep? What will help you?»

Grade 3: completes a planner with at least five items and washes a sock with a partner. **Grade 4:** adds times to every item and washes and wrings a sock alone. **Extension:** writes why each item matters (for example, «I cut my nails because germs hide under them») and coaches a partner at the basin.

Check. Stamp «I plan my care routine» and «I hand-wash socks». Children tick their planner at home for a week and bring it back.

Tip. Use the rinse water to water plants or wash the yard; nothing is wasted.

Lesson 3 · Organised Me (40 min)

Materials: the real class timetable on the board, children's school bags, a «messy bag» (a bag packed with the wrong books, an old sandwich wrapper, loose pencils), old newspaper or plastic bags for covering books, tape, children's uniform jumpers or shirts.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «Have you ever forgotten something you needed for school? What happened?»
2. **Messy bag (5 min).** Unpack the messy bag in front of the class. Children spot the problems. «A bag is ready when it has what tomorrow needs, and nothing it does not.»
3. **Pack from the timetable (12 min).** Children read tomorrow's subjects from the timetable and make a checklist in their journals. They empty their own bags, sort what stays and what goes home, then repack from the list. Partners check each other's bag against the list.
4. **Care for books and uniform (15 min).** Station A: cover a book with newspaper or a plastic bag and tape it. Station B: fold a uniform shirt or jumper neatly (sleeves in, fold in half, fold again) and hang a shirt on a chair back so it does not crease. Groups swap halfway.
5. **Close (5 min).** «When will you pack your bag: in the evening or the morning? Why is the evening better?»

Grade 3: packs from a checklist and covers a book with help. **Grade 4:** writes their own checklist from the timetable and folds the uniform alone. **Extension:** makes a weekly bag checklist for every day of the week and plans when to wash and iron uniform.

Check. Stamp «I pack my bag from the timetable» and «I care for my books and uniform».

Home practice. Tick your daily care routine planner every day for one week and show it to a family member each evening.

Module 2 · Healthy Body

Goals. Grade 3: draws a balanced plate with local foods and drinks water in the heat. Grade 4: spots sugar on labels and finds standing water. Extension: compares drinks using label numbers and explains how malaria spreads.

Lesson 1 · The Balanced Plate (40 min)

Materials: a large paper plate drawn on chart paper, food picture cards or real samples of local foods (attiéké, rice, placali, foutou, banane plantain, haricots, arachides, poisson braisé, egg, gombo, tomato, mangue, papaye, orange, ananas), paper plates, coloured pencils, journals. Allergy check before handling any real food, especially arachides.

1. **Circle (4 min).** «What did you eat yesterday evening?» Children name one dish each.
2. **Teach (8 min).** Draw the plate. Half: vegetables and fruit (gombo, tomato, aubergine, papaye). A quarter: energy foods (attiéké, rice, foutou, placali, alloco). A quarter: growing foods (fish, egg, haricots, arachides, chicken). A cup of clean water beside it. «Energy foods give us power to run and think. Growing foods build strong muscles. Fruit and vegetables protect us from getting sick.»
3. **Sort (10 min).** Groups sort the food cards or samples onto the class plate in the right sections. They argue their choices: «Where does garba go? What is missing to make it balanced?»
4. **Draw my plate (14 min).** Each child draws a balanced plate on a paper plate using a meal they really eat at home, labelling each food and its section. Partners check: half fruit and vegetables?
5. **Close (4 min).** Three children show their plates. «What one thing could you add to your next meal?»

Grade 3: draws a plate with foods in the right sections. **Grade 4:** turns a real family dish (for example garba) into a balanced plate by adding what is missing. **Extension:** plans a balanced breakfast, lunch and dinner for one day.

Check. Stamp «I plan a balanced plate». Talk about energy, growth and strength only; never body size or weight.

Tip. Picture cards cut from packets and magazines work as well as real food and cost nothing.

Lesson 2 · Sugar Detectives (40 min)

Materials: empty drink packets and bottles with nutrition labels (sachet juices, sodas, flavoured milk, bissap if labelled; ask families to send them clean), a bottle of water, a bag of sugar, a teaspoon, clear cups or small plates, a sugar chart in journals.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «What is your favourite drink?» Quick round.
2. **Teach (7 min).** Show where «sugars» is written on a label and the amount in grams. «In this class we will count one level teaspoon of sugar as 4 grams.» Model one label on the board: find sugar per bottle, divide by 4, and round to the nearest teaspoon.
3. **Detective work (12 min).** Groups take three drinks each. The reader finds the sugar line, the recorder writes the grams, the measurer works out the teaspoons. Teacher checks the maths group by group.
4. **Spoon line-up (13 min).** Each group spoons the right number of level teaspoons of sugar into a clear cup in front of their drink. Line up all the drinks and cups from least to most sugar. Water goes first with an empty cup. «Which surprised you?» Sugar stays in the cups; nobody eats it.
5. **Close (5 min).** «Sugar sticks to teeth and feeds the germs that make holes. What is the best drink when you are thirsty?» Children write one swap in their journals (for example, «water instead of a sachet juice at break»).

Grade 3: finds the sugar line on a label and measures teaspoons with the group. **Grade 4:** calculates teaspoons from grams. **Extension:** compares two drinks per 100 ml and explains why a bigger bottle can hide more sugar.

Check. Stamp «I find sugar on a label». Do not talk about weight, size or calories; talk about teeth, energy and water.

Tip. Keep the sugar afterwards for the compost lesson or the school kitchen; nothing goes to waste.

Lesson 3 · Beat the Heat, Beat Malaria (40 min)

Materials: water bottles, a hat and a long-sleeved shirt, a mosquito net (or a picture), a school grounds map drawn on chart paper, clipboards or journals, sticks for pointing, soap and water for handwashing afterwards.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «How do you feel when it is very hot at break? What do you do?»
2. **Beat the heat (7 min).** Children demonstrate: drink water before you feel thirsty, sit in the shade, wear a hat, play hard games in the cooler morning. Signs of too much heat: headache, dizzy, very tired, very thirsty. «If you feel like this, go to the shade, drink water and tell an adult.» Everyone drinks now.
3. **Teach malaria (7 min).** Malaria comes from the bite of a mosquito. Mosquitoes lay eggs in still water: old tyres, buckets, bottle caps, flower pots, blocked gutters. Protect yourself: sleep under a net every night, tuck it in, cover arms and legs at dusk, empty standing water. «If you have a fever, tell an adult straight away so you can see a nurse or doctor.» A child shows how to tuck in the net.
4. **Standing-water hunt (18 min).** Groups walk a set part of the school grounds in the shade, with an adult. They look for anywhere water could sit and mark it on the map: a cross for water found, a circle for a place that could hold water after rain. They do not touch dirty water; they point with a stick. The adult tips out any small containers they find.
5. **Close (5 min).** Groups report back. Everyone washes hands. Agree two places to check every week and who will check them.

Grade 3: names three ways to stay safe in the heat and two ways to prevent malaria. **Grade 4:** marks places on the map and explains why each one is a risk. **Extension:** writes a short report for the head of school with the places found and a fix for each.

Check. Stamp «I stay safe in the heat» and «I prevent malaria».

Tip. Do the hunt in the morning, keep groups in the shade between spots, and carry water.

Home practice. Do a standing-water hunt around your home with a family member and empty or cover anything that holds water.

Module 3 · Staying Safe

Goals. Grade 3: spots dangers at home and knows when to get an adult. Grade 4: treats a small cut, nosebleed or burn and makes a clear emergency call. Extension: explains why each first-aid step works and reads beach flags.

Lesson 1 · Home Hazard Hunt (40 min)

Materials: a picture of a house drawn on chart paper with hidden hazards (a gas bottle next to a charcoal stove, a frayed wire, a kerosene bottle in a soft-drink bottle, a pot handle sticking out, medicines on a low table, a bleach bottle by the sink), picture cards of the same hazards, journals.

1. **Circle (4 min).** «What is the most dangerous thing in a kitchen?» Quick round.
2. **Hazard hunt (10 min).** Groups study the house picture and circle every danger they can find. Then compare: «Who found the most? Did anyone miss the kerosene in the drink bottle?»
3. **Teach (8 min).** Go through each hazard with a rule. Gas bottle: keep it outside or far from flames; if you smell gas, do not touch switches, open the doors and get out, tell an adult. Charcoal stove: never indoors with doors closed, the smoke can make you very sick; keep small children away. Wires: never touch a broken wire or plug with wet hands. Kerosene and bleach: never store in drink bottles; never drink; tell an adult if you see it. Pot handles: turn them inward.
4. **Make it safe (13 min).** Groups take two hazard cards and act a short scene: a child spots the danger, says what it is, and tells an adult what to do. «Maman, the gas bottle is next to the stove. Can we move it?» Other groups name the rule.
5. **Close (5 min).** Each child writes three dangers they will look for at home this week.

Grade 3: finds and names five hazards. **Grade 4:** gives the safety rule for each hazard. **Extension:** draws a safe-kitchen plan showing where the gas bottle, stove and chemicals should go.

Check. Stamp «I spot dangers at home».

Tip. Use pictures only. Never bring real gas, kerosene or cleaning products into class.

Lesson 2 · First Aid Helpers (40 min)

Materials: plasters, gauze squares, a jug of clean water and a basin, a clock or timer, red marker for pretend cuts, first-aid step cards (small cut, nosebleed, burn), soap.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «Have you ever hurt yourself at home? Who helped you?» Keep answers short.
2. **Teach (9 min).** Three small injuries. Small cut: wash your hands, rinse the cut with clean water, press with clean gauze to stop bleeding, cover with a plaster. Nosebleed: sit down, lean forward, pinch the soft part of the nose for 10 minutes; do not tip the head back. Burn: cool it under cool running water for 20 minutes; never oil, toothpaste or butter. «Always tell an adult.»
3. **First-aid stations (18 min).** Three stations, groups rotate every 6 minutes. Cut: draw a small pretend cut on a partner's arm, rinse it with the jug, press with gauze, put on a plaster. Nosebleed: partner sits, leans forward and pinches; the helper watches the clock. Burn: pour cool water from the jug over the partner's hand into the basin and say how long it must last.
4. **Get an adult (6 min).** Read scenario cards aloud; children show thumbs up (I can help) or hand up (get an adult now): big cut that will not stop bleeding, burn bigger than a hand, a bump on the head, a child who will not wake up. «If you are not sure, get an adult.»
5. **Close (4 min).** Each child says one rule without looking at the cards.

Grade 3: shows the steps for a cut and a nosebleed with the card. **Grade 4:** shows all three without the card and knows when to get an adult. **Extension:** explains why: why lean forward, why 20 minutes of water, why no butter.

Check. Stamp «I treat a small cut», «I help a nosebleed», «I cool a burn». This lesson teaches awareness and when to get help; real injuries go to the school's first-aid lead.

Tip. If a child becomes upset or shares a worrying injury story, follow the safeguarding policy and tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead.

Lesson 3 · Emergency Call (40 min)

Materials: toy or old phones (or phones made from cardboard), number cards 170, 180, 185, an emergency-call card (my name, the place, what happened, stay on the line), beach-flag cards (green, yellow, red), a motorbike helmet or a picture.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «Who knows a number to call for help?»
2. **Teach (7 min).** Police 170 (also 110 or 111), Pompiers 180 for fires and accidents, SAMU 185 for someone very sick or badly hurt. A good call: «My name is Ama. I am at the house next to the Mosquée, Quartier France, Grand-Bassam. My grandmother fell and is not waking up.» Answer questions and do not hang up until they tell you.
3. **Call role-play (14 min).** Pairs: caller and operator. The operator gives a scenario card (kitchen fire, a man fallen from a motorbike, a stranger trying to break in). The caller chooses the number, dials, and gives name, place and what happened. The operator asks, «Where exactly?» Swap roles.
4. **Beach and road safety (11 min).** Beach flags: green, swimming with care and an adult; yellow, be careful, stay in shallow water; red, no swimming. Grand-Bassam's sea has strong waves and currents that pull people out. «Swim only with an adult, only where a lifeguard is, only when the flag allows. If the water pulls you, do not fight it: float, raise a hand and shout.» Then helmets: «On a motorbike, everyone wears a helmet, fastened.» Children practise fastening a helmet and the road crossing: look left, right, then left again.
5. **Close (5 min).** Children write their home address or nearest landmark and their parent's phone number in their journal to learn by heart.

Grade 3: chooses the right number and gives name and place. **Grade 4:** gives a full call with what happened and answers questions calmly. **Extension:** explains what each beach flag means and why currents are dangerous even for good swimmers.

Check. Stamp «I make an emergency call» and «I know the beach flags».

Tip. Practise on toy phones only. Remind children never to call real emergency numbers for a game.

Home practice. Learn your home address and a parent's phone number by heart, and walk round your home with a family member to find one danger to fix.

Module 4 · Helping at Home

Goals. Grade 3: follows a no-cook recipe and sews a running stitch with help. Grade 4: measures accurately, sews a neat running stitch and hand-washes a small item alone. Extension: adapts a recipe for more people and plans a family chore chart.

Lesson 1 · Recipe Readers (40 min)

Materials: a recipe card for each group (avocado and tomato sandwich, or fruit salad of mangue, papaye, banane and ananas), bread, ripe avocados, tomatoes, a lemon or lime, salt, blunt table knives, plastic plates, spoons, measuring cups and spoons, a bowl per group, basin, soap and water. Allergy check before the lesson.

1. **Circle and hands (5 min).** Everyone washes hands with soap. «What is the first thing a cook does?»
2. **Read the recipe (6 min).** Groups read their card aloud: ingredients, amounts, steps. Show what «½ cup», «1 teaspoon» and «a pinch» look like. Knife rules: knife flat on the board or plate, cut away from your hand, knife down when you talk.
3. **Prepare (18 min).** Groups follow the recipe step by step. The reader reads, the measurer measures, the others cut and mix with blunt table knives. Adults cut anything hard (pineapple skin, firm tomato into halves). Sandwich: mash the avocado with a fork, add a squeeze of lime and a pinch of salt, spread, add tomato slices. Fruit salad: cut fruit into small pieces, measure 1 cup of each fruit into the bowl, add a squeeze of orange.
4. **Eat and tidy (8 min).** Share and taste. Each group washes its plates and knives in the basin and wipes the table.
5. **Close (3 min).** «Which step was hardest? What would you change next time?»

Grade 3: follows the steps in order with the group. **Grade 4:** measures each ingredient correctly. **Extension:** rewrites the recipe for double the number of people.

Check. Stamp «I follow a recipe» and «I use a table knife safely».

Tip. Buy fruit the same morning and keep it covered. Food is eaten the same day.

Lesson 2 · Needle and Thread (40 min)

Materials: large blunt needles (one per child, counted out and in), thick thread or wool, squares of sacking or loose-weave pagne scrap, chalk to draw stitch lines, a needle-threading card (cardboard with a hole), scissors for the teacher.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «Who in your family sews? What do they make?»
2. **Needle rules (5 min).** Count needles out. Needles stay in the cloth or the needle card, never in mouths or on chairs. Pass a needle point-down.
3. **Thread it (8 min).** Practise on the cardboard card first: wet or twist the thread end, push it through the eye, pull a tail through, tie a knot at the long end. Then thread a real needle. Partners help each other.
4. **Running stitch (19 min).** Children draw a straight chalk line on their sacking. Model: needle up, needle down, same-sized stitches, same-sized gaps. «Up and down, like a fish jumping in the lagoon.» Children sew a straight line, then a curve or their initial. Finish with two small stitches on the back to lock it.
5. **Close (5 min).** Count needles back in. Children hold up their work; partners give one star for neat stitches.

Grade 3: threads a needle with help and sews a straight running stitch. **Grade 4:** threads alone and keeps stitches even. **Extension:** sews their initial or joins two pieces of cloth with a running stitch to start a small bag.

Check. Stamp «I thread a needle» and «I sew a running stitch».

Tip. Sacking from rice or flour sacks has large holes and is free; it makes sewing easier for beginners.

Lesson 3 · Wash It, Hang It (40 min)

Materials: handkerchiefs or socks (children bring one from home), two basins, bar soap, a jug, a washing line or string and clothes pegs, chore chart template in journals.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «What jobs do you already do at home?»
2. **Demonstrate (5 min).** Model the steps: soak, soap, scrub, rinse, squeeze, shake, hang. Point out stains: «Rub soap right on the mark and scrub cloth against cloth.»
3. **Wash it, hang it (17 min).** Pairs wash their item at the basins without help, rinse in clean water, wring it out, shake it flat and peg it out in the sun by the corners. Then they empty the dirty water on plants or the garden.
4. **Chore chart (11 min).** Each child makes a weekly chore chart for home with three jobs (for example: sweep the yard, wash my socks, set the table) and a tick box for each day. They write who in the family will check it.
5. **Close (4 min).** Check the washing line: is everything clean and hung straight? «Which chore will you start tonight?»

Grade 3: washes and hangs an item with a partner and chooses two chores. **Grade 4:** washes, wrings and hangs an item alone and plans three chores. **Extension:** makes a chore chart for the whole family, sharing jobs fairly.

Check. Stamp «I hand-wash and hang clothes» and «I do my chores». Soap and water only; no bleach or other products.

Home practice. Follow your chore chart for one week and help prepare one simple no-cook dish with your family.

Module 5 · Money Smart

Goals. Grade 3: gives change from 500 FCFA and tells needs from wants. Grade 4: gives change from 1,000 FCFA, compares prices and makes a savings plan. Extension: works out savings time and the best value for money.

Lesson 1 · Making Change (40 min)

Materials: real coins (5, 10, 25, 50, 100, 200, 250, 500 FCFA) and notes (500, 1,000, 2,000 FCFA) in a closed tin, counted out and in; price tags for small items (a pen 150 FCFA, a mango 200, a bread 250, a bag of arachides 100, a bissap 300, a notebook 450, a pencil set 650); journals.

1. **Circle (3 min).** Count the money out together. Children name each coin and note as it is shown.
2. **Teach (8 min).** Making change by counting on. «Kofi buys bread for 250 and pays 500. Start at 250 and count up: 250, 300, 400, 500. The change is 250.» Repeat with 1,000: «A notebook is 450. Count up: 450, 500, 1,000. The change is 550.»
3. **Shop and change (19 min).** Groups of four set up a stall with three priced items. Roles: seller, two buyers, checker. Buyers pay with a 500 FCFA coin or 1,000 FCFA note; the seller counts on and gives change; the checker writes the sum in a journal. Rotate every 4 to 5 minutes.
4. **Change challenge (6 min).** Quick board problems: «Awa pays 1,000 for two mangoes at 200 each. What is her change?» Children work in journals, then show answers.
5. **Close (4 min).** Count every coin and note back into the tin.

Grade 3: gives change from 500 FCFA by counting on. **Grade 4:** gives change from 1,000 FCFA for one or two items. **Extension:** gives change from 2,000 FCFA and finds the fewest coins for the change.

Check. Stamp «I give change from 500 FCFA» and «I give change from 1,000 FCFA».

Tip. If coins are short, use real notes and printed card coins together, but give each group at least a few real coins to handle.

Lesson 2 · Market Detectives (40 min)

Materials: price lists children collected at home with their families the week before (prices of the same items from two sellers or the market and the boutique), a class price chart on the board, real coins and notes, journals.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «Who went to the market with a family member? What did you see?»
2. **Compare prices (12 min).** Groups put their family prices into a table: item, price at place A, price at place B, difference. «Where is the tomato cheapest? By how much?» Discuss why prices change: season, size, quantity (a tas of tomatoes versus one tomato).
3. **Teach bargaining (6 min).** In the market, many sellers expect a polite bargain; in shops with fixed prices we do not bargain. Model respectful bargaining: greet first, ask the price, offer a fair price, smile, accept or thank and walk on. «Bonjour, Maman. C'est combien? … Can you do 400? … Merci, bonne journée.» Never insult the seller or their goods.
4. **Bargain role-play (14 min).** Pairs: seller and buyer, with real money and a price card. The seller sets a starting price and a lowest price written secretly; the buyer bargains politely and pays. Class watches two pairs and names what was respectful.
5. **Close (5 min).** Journal: «The best place to buy ___ is ___ because ___.»

Grade 3: compares two prices and finds the cheaper. **Grade 4:** works out the difference and bargains politely. **Extension:** compares price for quantity (one tomato versus a tas) to find the best value.

Check. Stamp «I compare prices» and «I bargain politely».

Tip. Send the price-list slip home the Friday before, English first, then French. Prices families give are real; do not correct them.

Lesson 3 · My Savings Plan (40 min)

Materials: savings plan template in journals (my goal, cost, how much I save each week, how many weeks), need and want picture cards, job cards (fisherman, market seller, teacher, nurse, moto-taxi driver, tailor, farmer, mechanic), real coins in a tin.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «If you saved some money, what would you buy?»
2. **Needs and wants (7 min).** Groups sort cards into needs (food, water, school shoes, a mosquito net) and wants (sweets, a toy, a new ball). Some are both: discuss.
3. **Where money comes from (8 min).** Each group takes job cards. «What does this person do? Who pays them? What do they need to learn?» Children act one job for the class to guess. «Money is earned by work.»
4. **My savings plan (17 min).** Model: «Yao wants a football that costs 2,500 FCFA. He saves 250 FCFA a week. How many weeks?» Count it out with real coins. Children write their own plan: a goal, its cost, a weekly saving and the number of weeks. Partners check the maths.
5. **Close (5 min).** «What want will you skip to help you save?» Count money back into the tin.

Grade 3: sorts needs and wants and writes a goal and its cost. **Grade 4:** completes the full plan with the number of weeks. **Extension:** plans what happens if they save more or less each week and compares the two plans.

Check. Stamp «I tell needs from wants» and «I make a savings plan».

Home practice. Go to the market or a boutique with a family member, help pay, and check the change.

Module 6 · Caring for Our Planet

Goals. Grade 3: explains how plastic reaches the lagoon and beach, and cares for a garden plot. Grade 4: runs a waste audit and starts a compost. Extension: uses the audit data to suggest a fix and plans water saving.

Lesson 1 · The Plastic Problem (40 min)

Materials: a tray or cardboard model with sand, a «gutter» made from a cut bottle, and a basin for the «lagoon»; small pieces of clean plastic (sachet water bags, caps, wrappers); a jug of water; waste-audit tally sheet; gloves or tongs; journals.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «What rubbish have you seen on the beach or near the lagoon?»
2. **Model the journey (10 min).** Scatter clean plastic on the sand «street». Pour water from the jug like heavy rain. Watch the plastic wash into the gutter and down into the «lagoon». «Where does the lagoon go? Into the sea. Where do the waves bring it? Back to our beach.»
3. **Teach (7 min).** Plastic does not rot; it breaks into tiny pieces that fish and birds eat. Plastic in gutters also blocks water and makes puddles where mosquitoes breed. Ways to help: put rubbish in a bin, use a reusable bottle and bag, say no to extra sachets.
4. **Start the waste audit (15 min).** For one week the class will count what goes into the class bin. Groups design the tally sheet (plastic, paper, food, other). Today, wearing gloves or using tongs, they sort today's class bin onto newspaper and record the first count. Everyone washes hands after.
5. **Close (5 min).** Agree who sorts and counts each day this week. «What do you think we throw away most?»

Grade 3: explains the journey of plastic from street to beach. **Grade 4:** sets up and records the tally. **Extension:** predicts the week's total and suggests one change to reduce the biggest type of waste.

Check. Stamp «I explain how plastic reaches the lagoon». Review the full week's audit at the next Life Skills lesson.

Tip. Sort only the dry class bin, never the toilet or kitchen bins.

Lesson 2 · Compost and Soil (40 min)

Materials: large plastic bottles with tops cut off by an adult (one per group), soil, dry leaves, fruit and vegetable peels, newspaper scraps, a little water, items that do not rot (a plastic cap, a can ring, a glass bead), «rots or does not rot» cards, gloves, permanent marker. Option: a small pit dug in a corner of the garden.

1. **Circle (3 min).** Share the waste audit results. «How much of our waste was food or paper? Could it go back into the soil?»
2. **Rots or not (8 min).** Groups sort cards and real items: peels, leaves, paper, eggshells, bread (rot); plastic, glass, metal, sachets (do not rot). «Things that rot become food for plants. That is compost.»
3. **Build a bottle compost (17 min).** Groups layer their bottle: soil, dry leaves, peels, newspaper, soil, a little water. Repeat until full. Add one plastic cap at the side as a test. Poke small air holes with a pencil. Label with the group name and date. If you have a garden pit, one group starts the pit in the same way.
4. **Plan care (7 min).** Teach care: keep it damp, not wet; turn or shake gently each week; no meat, oil or plastic. Groups draw what they expect to see in four weeks in their journals.
5. **Close (5 min).** Wash hands. Place bottles in the shade. «What will happen to the peel? What will happen to the cap?»

Grade 3: sorts what rots and helps build the compost. **Grade 4:** builds the layers in order and explains each one. **Extension:** keeps a weekly observation log (smell, colour, what has gone) and explains what happened to the cap.

Check. Stamp «I know what can rot» and «I start a compost».

Tip. An adult cuts the bottles with scissors before the lesson. Children do not use blades on plastic.

Lesson 3 · School Garden Team (40 min)

Materials: a garden plot or large containers (cut jerrycans, sacks filled with soil), compost from the class or the garden, seeds or seedlings (gombo, piment, tomato or haricots), a watering can or bottles with holes in the cap, sticks and string, a watering rota chart, dry leaves for mulch, gloves for handling piment.

1. **Circle (3 min).** «What grows in your family's garden or in the village?»
2. **Prepare the bed (9 min).** Groups clear stones and weeds, loosen the soil with sticks and mix in compost. Mark straight rows with string.
3. **Plant (12 min).** Model then let groups plant: a hole two fingers deep for beans and gombo, shallower for tomato and piment seeds; space them a hand apart; cover and press gently. Label each row. Anyone touching piment wears gloves and does not touch their eyes.
4. **Saving water and the rota (11 min).** Teach: water early morning or late afternoon, water at the roots not the leaves, cover the soil with dry leaves to keep it damp, use rinse water from washing fruit. Children water their rows with a bottle can. Groups make the watering rota: two children per day, names and days written on the chart.
5. **Close (5 min).** Wash hands. «How will we know if our plants are thirsty?» Agree when to check for the first shoots.

Grade 3: plants seeds correctly and waters at the roots. **Grade 4:** follows the rota and explains two ways to save water. **Extension:** keeps a growth log (height, leaves, date) and plans what to do if a plant looks sick.

Check. Stamp «I care for a garden plot» and «I save water». Check the rota is followed for two weeks.

Tip. Work in the shade between tasks and keep drinking water close. Grow beans in cups for children with no space at home.

Home practice. Count the plastic your family throws away in one day and choose one piece you could reuse or refuse next time.